围城漫谈
The Story of a Besieged Town

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开场

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An old friend gave me an interesting new topic to investigate.
我的旧友为我带来了一个有趣的课题。

She claimed that somewhere in the far East, lies a hidden, ancient land, where works of fine fabrics and porcelain are created with staggering beauty.
东方的东方，隐秘的古国，那些美丽织物与青白陶瓷为我们带来了适宜的风采。

The opportunity to explore this land is simply too valuable to pass up.
如今，这正是一个适合探寻的机会。

In the dead of night, in the overgrown places far from the crowds. Faint rustling sounds spring from out-of-sight places, where rodents scurry and snakes chase close behind.
夤夜，人迹罕至的郊外，狭窄，静谧，草木丛生。四周有隐约的细响，在目所不能及之处，正有鼠蛇经行。

Every city has its outskirts.
每一个城市都会有这样的地方。

And today, a curious visitor has arrived in one such place.
但在今日，这儿来了一位新奇的客人。

Drifting in the air, too slender to be a bird yet too broad to be a butterfly, trembling, wavering up and down.
飘在半空中，说是鸟儿过于单薄，说是蝴蝶又过于宽阔。正在颤抖，上下游弋。

Pandora Wilson: *coughs*
白雪松：咳……咳咳……！

Pandora Wilson: The letter has gotten damp ... that's sure to affect the way it carries my voice.
白雪松：这次的信纸有些受潮了，我的声音也变得不同往日。

Pandora Wilson: But I won't let it affect the interview ... And we don't have more paper to spare.
白雪松：但没关系，这不会影响采访……而我们所剩的信纸也并不多了。

The snow-white letter bears a dried watermark. A mouth transferring her voice. To any observer, it would appear it was talking to itself.
一封雪白的信，带着烘干后留下的水印。她像是自言自语，也像是正与某人对话。

Pandora Wilson: In any case, a trip like this is certain to be worthwhile. Things here are much different from the West. There are whole new art forms to be discovered and reported.
白雪松：无论如何，这场旅行总是值得的，这里的一切都与西方不同。全新的艺术形式正运用其中。

Pandora Wilson: The dimensions, the fragrance note, the exhibition site, and the medium are all a great unknown to us. It's ... intriguing, to say the least.
白雪松：尺寸、香调、周转经历与其特殊的介质都是未知的，它……多么令人好奇。

But her thoughts are interrupted by movement in the distance.
远处传来一阵异动。

Pandora Wilson: ... Hm?
白雪松：……嗯?

Pandora Wilson: The growing tremors soon eclipse all other considerations, as the grass and trees begin to shiver, causing a shower of leaves to fall.
白雪松：大地的震颤先于一切，草木战栗。叶片不住地落下，发出细细的嚎叫。

Then comes a clattering sound, intense and rhythmic, followed by a mix of whinnies.
随后传来了“哒哒”的声响，密集而错落有致。她听见其中混杂着几声嘶鸣。

Pandora Wilson: What could that be, beasts or birds? No, it wouldn't be anything so dramatic—
白雪松：这是什么声音，有兽群，或是鸟儿？不，不应该有如此巨大的——

A whirlwind extinguishes her speculation. Feathers flutter and an immense shadow looms.
旋风吹熄臆测猜想，羽翼扑朔，硕大无朋的阴影笼罩而上。

The sudden downdraft blows the letter over. As it falls, a gentle man's voice pierces the night.
信纸被掀倒在地，紧接着一道男声由上方传来。

???: Apologies, I did not intend to knock you over.
???：抱歉，我并非有意使你跌倒。

The gale ceases. Soft feathers gently reach for the letter, propping it upright.
狂风停止。柔软的羽稍轻轻地触碰了信纸，试图将它摆放端正。

The creature has a human face, but in place of his "hands" are a pair of large feathered wings, and below them ... sharp talons. He is a "birdman."
这是一位“鸟先生”——他长着人的面孔，双手却是一对巨大的鸟翼，趾爪尖利。

Pandora Wilson: You're a ... cri- ... No, you can't be a critter. Are you an arcanist from the East?
白雪松：你是……魔……不，不是魔精，你是一位东方神秘学家?

Pandora Wilson: So, there are bird-like humanoids in the East ...
白雪松：原来在东方，也有如此巨大的鸟形类人生物……

Words fail her, but her hunches never did. She is entirely sure of what she has seen.
言语不通，但猜想总不会错。她对自己的眼光总是如此笃定。

Pandora Wilson: A perfect chance for an interview ... I'll need a drop of "Miracle Conversation" Potion. It helps us understand each other.
白雪松：这是一个采访的机会……没错，服用一滴“交谈妙法”魔药，它会帮助我们。

The "birdman" tilts his head slightly.
“鸟先生”微微歪头。

Having the same thought as the letter, he lowers his head and pulls out a bone flute that has been hidden among the feathery tufts on the inside of his wings.
与雪白信纸同样地，他低下头，在怀中探索，露出翅膀内侧羽绒簇拥中隐藏的骨笛。

Getian: The tip of the bone flute traces a strange symbol into the air, and the familiar glow of an arcane skill appears with it.
葛天：骨杖的尖端在空中描画出一个奇异的符号，神秘术的辉光随之乍现。

???: You are an object with neither bones nor form ...
???：此乃，无骨无相之物……

The syllables the bird speaks are completely unfamiliar to her, yet she understands them clearly.
本应陌生的音节，落入耳中，变成易于理解的信息。

It is incredible, almost unimaginable.
不可思议，难以想象。

???: Now we can communicate.
???：如今我们就可以交谈了。

Pandora Wilson: This must be a new Arcane Skill from the East, one that allows us to understand each other's language.
白雪松：你……施展了来自东方的神秘术，而它的功效使得我们能够理解对方的语言。

Pandora Wilson: Great, then I don't need to use this potion anymore.
白雪松： 很好，现在我不需要用到这份魔药了。

Putting away the gleaming vial, the letter circles the bird before stopping in front of him.
收起闪着金光的小瓶，信纸围绕巨鸟转了一圈，最终停在他的面前。

A business card matching the letter floats down from the air, landing on his thick feathers.
一张雪白的名片从空中飘下，落在厚厚的羽毛上。

Pandora Wilson: Hello.
白雪松： 你好。

???: ... Hello.
???: ……你好。

Pandora Wilson: I am Pandora Wilson, interviewer and editor-in-chief for UTTU Magazine.
白雪松： 我是来自 UTTU 杂志社的白雪松，担任主编与采访记者的职务。

Pandora Wilson: I have come from a faraway place in the West, to find new things to learn and to give a report on them.
白雪松： 我从遥远的西方来，是为了见证而来，也为了了解而来。

Pandora Wilson: Let's start with the most fundamental question. Sir, what should I call you?
白雪松： 让我们从“采访”最初的问题开始吧，先生，我该如何称呼你?

Getian: ... I am Gětiān.
葛天： ……我名葛天。

Pandora Wilson: That rings to me like a typical Eastern name.
白雪松： 典型的东方名字。

Pandora Wilson: Yet sir, according to all available evidence I have seen, it seems far from typical for people here to have wings as you do.
白雪松： 先生，我见过东方的画册，里面绝大部分的人，并不似你这般生有双翼。

Pandora Wilson: In the West, we also have winged humanoids. Only, they were exclusively female. The children of Typhon and Echidna, we called them Harpies.
白雪松： 在我居住的西方，也有与你相似的生物。当然，她们之中仅有女性，她们是提丰与厄客德娜的孩子，被人们称之为哈耳庇厄。

Pandora Wilson: They were once masters of the wind, until they became messengers of bad news and synonymous with evil.
白雪松： 她们曾是风的主人，而后成为邪恶的代名，不幸消息的传令者。

Getian: ... I am no messenger.
葛天： ……我并非传令者。

Pandora Wilson: That much is obvious, sir.
白雪松： 这是显而易见的，先生。

The voice lets out a short laugh.
信纸里侧发出一阵短促的笑声。

Pandora Wilson: You must, I gather, be a herder of these striped horses ... They're a breed I've never seen before—are you a local here?
白雪松： 你在放牧，而这些斑纹马……也是我从未见过的品种——你是这城里的牧人?

Getian: These are not truly horses ... and, no.
葛天： 这些并非马匹，我也并非城中人。

Getian: ... I am from the mountains.
葛天： ……我从山上来。

Pandora Wilson: A tall mountain? Is it far from here?
白雪松：那是一座高山吗？距离这里十分遥远？

Getian: It is.
葛天：也许算是。

Pandora Wilson: I see you're alone, except for those horses. I've heard some birds push their young out of the nest to hone their abilities; is this journey part of your "rite of passage?"
白雪松：你没有同伴，独身而来。我听闻过猛禽有将孩子推出巢穴来锻炼其能力的习性，这次出行是你的“成年试炼”吗？

Getian: ... No, my family are gone now, they did not push me out.
葛天：……不，山中已没有家人等待，我也并非被推搡离开。

Striped Horse: *neighs*
斑纹马：咴——

The strange horses whinny, running out of patience at their long stop.
斑纹马们嘶鸣不断，耐心告罄。

Getian: ... I am, otherwise occupied.
葛天：……我此刻，另有要事。

Getian: I can see our meeting was not a mere coincidence. If you have any other questions, they must wait until next time.
葛天：骨相所言，我与你，并非缘悭一面。若有他事，亦可留待下次再谈。

Pandora Wilson: When and where will this "next time" be?
白雪松：你说再会，是在什么时间、什么地点？

Pandora Wilson: We'll have to make arrangements, how else can we be sure to meet again?
白雪松：不做约定，如何确信我们能够再次相遇？

Gětiān looks towards the restless herd.
葛天静静地注视着躁动的马群。

Faint cries of birds called out in the distance. He sighs deeply, then spreads his wings and takes flight.
远处隐约传来了禽类鸣叫之声。他深深地叹了一口气，而后张开双翼，腾飞起身。

Pandora Wilson: This interview is not over yet, sir—
白雪松：我们的采访还没有结束，先生——

She is answered by a gust of wind.
回答她的是一阵猛烈的风声。

The "birdman" arcanist flies off into the distance, with the striped herd following him.
似人似鸟的神秘学家飞向了远方，斑纹马们亦随之离去了。

Pandora Wilson: A strange disturbance and a solitary outsider ... It seems something is happening in this town. I arrived just in time.
白雪松：一场骚动，一个离群索居的外来者……看来这座城中正有事发生，我来的正是时候。

Pandora Wilson: I have to go and see what sort of story is unfolding here.
白雪松：跟上去，瞧瞧这里的故事吧。

The letter floats through the air, following the tracks left by the striped horses, as best it can.
信纸飘飘荡荡，咬着斑纹马们消失的行迹紧随其后。

Unfortunately, journalism is her strong suit, not tracking.
不同于采访，跟踪并不是她的强项。

Pandora Wilson: They've vanished. Where could they have gone?
白雪松：它们的痕迹消失了，它们去哪儿了？

Pandora Wilson: Not even a trace of their hoof prints ...
白雪松：只是一个瞬间，连脚印都消失无踪了……

Pandora Wilson: I can sense the use of some Arcane Skill ... Yet the only means of such swift mass displacement I'm aware of are the floppy disks of the St. Pavlov Foundation. Could they have a matching form of technology here in the East?
白雪松：能感觉到神秘术的使用痕迹……目前能够如此快捷地发动群体转移的术式，应当只有圣洛夫基金会的软盘才对，东方也有这样的技术吗？

"Chirp, chirp ... Caw caw ..."
吱吱、吱……咯咯……

Pandora Wilson: ... That sounds like a very large bird? Perhaps, Mr. Gětiān has returned ...
白雪松：……那是，鸟的声音？是葛天先生？

Pandora Wilson: No, though they are somewhat similar. Mr. Gětiān has a longer neck, and he isn't so round ...
白雪松：是的，他们之间是有些相似，身有两翼。但他的脖子更长些，体型也不是一个圆形……

Zhuye the Monster: Chirp! Caw caw caw!!!!
烛夜：吱！咯咯咯！！！！

Pandora Wilson: —! Wait, don't—
白雪松：——！等等，别——

The stench of alcohol washes over her. Obviously not all "birds" have the same sense of manners.
酒气汹涌，很显然，并非所有“鸟类”都算得上是同一回事。

Outside a tavern, two slightly tipsy locals walk through the street.
酒坊之外，两位酒至微醺的居民途经此处。

Citizen I: Oh—what's that racket, did someone break something?
城中居民 I：哎哟——又是什么东西被打碎了，这么大的声响？

Citizen II: Sounds like it's coming from Jiǔ Niángzǐ's tavern ...?
城中居民 II：我怎么听着，那声音像是从曲娘的酒坊里传出来的……

Citizen II: Ah, it's likely some Zhúyè troublemakers sneaking in for another drink.
城中居民 II：哎，八成是那烛夜又来偷酒喝了吧？它们不安生，总是捣乱！

Citizen II: Last time, they pushed a jar of goldfish into a liquor jar—what a shock that was for Jiǔ Niángzǐ when she found it in the morning!
城中居民 II：上次它们闹腾的时候，就把装金鱼的瓮都推到了酒坛子里——曲娘早上发现的时候，可吓了一跳呢！

Citizen I: We really should let her know.
城中居民 I：哎呀，那可得知会曲娘一声。

Citizen I: These Zhúyè are troublesome little things. She'll have to make the fence even higher next time.
城中居民 I：烛夜这小东西，属实麻烦。到时候得让她再把篱笆加高点儿。

Citizen I: They can't be allowed to ruin all that good liquor!
城中居民 I：辛苦酿的酒，可不能被它们这样糟蹋！

They look at one another, nodding their heads in unison, and begin calling out loudly and knocking on the door.
他们说着，连连点头，高声呼唤着，敲起门来。

Citizen II: Jiǔ Niángzǐ! Jiǔ Niángzǐ!
城中居民 Ⅱ： 曲娘！曲娘子！

Citizen I: The Zhúyè are wreaking havoc in your tavern again!
城中居民 Ⅰ： 烛夜又闹起来了，当心啊！

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???: Shoo, shoo, shoo—what a mess these Zhúyè have made again!
???: 去、去、去——这讨厌的烛夜，又来捣乱了！

Thumping stomps and a feather duster whipping the air mixed roughly with a chorus of caws.
摔打声，鸡毛掸子在空气中抽出呼呼风声，咯咯啼声混成一片。

Citizen II: Ah! Shoo! Shoo! Begone—begone! Good, we've sent them flying.
城中居民 Ⅱ： 嘿！去！去！好了——好了！都赶跑了！

Citizen I: This fence will not be enough to keep them out anymore, you ought to raise it higher ...
城中居民 Ⅰ： 这篱笆已经防不住它们了，可得再加高一些……

The voices, sometimes distant, sometimes near, were indistinct and fragmented.
声音时远时近，模糊散碎。

???: Of course. Thank you ... Oh, next time ... Of course, of course—
???: 当然，谢谢你们……哦，下次……当然当然——

Words of thanks, farewells, and the sound of a door locking are followed by footsteps.
道谢声，告别声，门落锁的声音，然后是脚步声。

The owner of the tavern returns to the messy courtyard alone, complaining to herself as she tidies up the overturned liquor jars.
酒坊主人独自回到乱糟糟的院子中，一面抱怨，一面整理起四下翻倒的酒坛。

Unaware of her guest, who has been hidden in the mess.
她尚未知道，自己有一位客人，正在安静地等待。

Pandora Wilson: ... Some people would call me lucky, to be soaked through with liquor ... But I never cared for drinking.
白雪松： ……我不喜欢饮酒，如今却泡在其中，生活如此幽默。

???: Huh?
???: 嗯?

???: Did this jar of liquor just ... Speak?
???: 这坛子酒……刚刚是不是说话了?

The footsteps grow closer, then halt. The tilted liquor jar straightens and returns to its place.
脚步声停在近前。倾斜的酒坛被扶正放好。

Gush—The liquor spills out, and a rush of cool air chills the soaked paper, and brings to its vision a moonlit place with flickering candles and a puzzled face.
“哗——”酒液四散着逃开。氤氲的烛光、微凉的空气，伴随着一张微讶的面孔，连同月光一并涌入了酒瓮之中。

Jiu Niangzi: Oh dear! Another letter from those scholars! And it's gotten soaked in this liquor! What a waste ...
曲娘： 啊呀！怎么又是那些书生的信！平白坏了我一坛子好酒！

The black-haired girl exclaims to herself, as she fishes out the letter from the liquor jar.
黑发姑娘大呼小叫着，从酒瓮中捞起了信纸。

Pandora Wilson: Hold on, I'm not just some letter!
白雪松：我并非一封信，小姐。

Jiu Niangzi: So it's a letter that talks? Ah! Talking paper ... this must be the work of Mr. Wú.
曲娘：这信……还会说话？啊！又是吴生！他又弄了这种会发声的纸来了——

Jiu Niangzi: That red paper lotus flower he gave me for my birthday sang for four days before it finally stopped!
曲娘：上次我过生辰时他送的红纸莲花，足足在我家里唱了四天歌儿才停下来呢！

Jiu Niangzi: I told him to stop sending things like this, they just make my head hurt—!
曲娘：我明明和他说了别再送这种东西了，吵得我脑袋疼——！

Pandora Wilson: Let me—go. Hey—!
白雪松：请放开——我，嘿——！

Jiu Niangzi: It must have been damaged, I can't understand what it's saying. What on earth did he write?
曲娘：这话叽里咕噜的，一点也听不懂，他到底写了什么？

Jiu Niangzi: Never mind. Despite the annoyance, it would be wrong to throw it away ...
曲娘：罢了罢了，哪怕是这种纸，是信就得好好收着……

The communication arcane skill cast by the "birdman" has obviously dissipated. Their words are unintelligible to one another.
来自“鸟先生”的神秘术显然已经散去，言语不通，难以交流。

The girl's hands move quickly as she mutters to herself. She sticks a grain of rice to the letter and smooths it out against the wall.
姑娘手下动作很快，口中碎碎地念叨着，一颗饭粒子贴上纸背，展平了就要向墙上贴去。

Pandora Wilson: —!
白雪松：——！

This is the perfect opportunity. The letter struggles out of her grip, regaining its freedom.
绝佳的机会，上墙脱手的一瞬间，信纸挣扎出来，重获自由。

A small bottle of golden liquid swiftly opened. And a drop of potion falls onto the paper, absorbing instantaneously.
盛着金色液体的小瓶飞速转开盖子，一滴魔药落在纸上，转眼就被吸收得干干净净。

Pandora Wilson: Is this—how you treat—guests? Miss—!
白雪松：这——就是你的——待客之道吗？小姑娘——！

Jiu Niangzi: Ah! Why ... Why is the letter struggling like this?!
曲娘：呀！这信……这信怎么还会动的呀！

Jiu Niangzi: So ... fierce ... I wonder which scholar could have sent you? If only I knew what you were saying ...
曲娘：还这么……这么凶巴巴的……你到底是哪个书生送来的信？写的又是什么意思？

The paper shakes itself forcefully, matching Jiǔ Niángzǐ's dumbfounded stare. Certainly, a poem of love wouldn't behave like this.
情诗不该如此。曲娘目瞪口呆之中，信纸再次用力地抖了一抖身子。

Her wall is covered with love poems, all their meanings are quite clear. The letter scoffs coldly.
墙上贴满了情诗，其中意味一目了然。她冷冷地嗤笑一声。

Pandora Wilson: "By the jade palace in spring, selling liquor in the shop. I wish to be joined with my love. Does she know how I long for her?"
白雪松: “玉楼春畔，当垆卖酒。愿结同心，佳人知否?”

Pandora Wilson: Hmph ... Simplistic, vulgar, dull, clichéd.
白雪松: 哼……庸俗、无趣的陈词滥调。

Pandora Wilson: I'm nothing like this trite, sycophantic rubbish—
白雪松: 我可不是这些谄媚、不真诚的不可回收垃圾的伙伴——

Jiu Niangzi: Ah ... So you're not another love-struck scholar's letter?
曲娘: 啊……原来你不是书生的信呀?

Jiǔ Niángzǐ blinks and leans in for a closer look.
曲娘子眨眨眼睛，凑近了仔细观瞧。

Jiu Niangzi: Sure enough ... Your paper is different, and your ink is too. You have a different smell, and your writing is ... well it's very different indeed. So, not from a scholar, after all.
曲娘: 也是了……你们纸张不同，用墨不同，气味不同，字儿的粗细也不同，你的确不是书生的信……

Jiu Niangzi: Oh, I ... Ms. Mouth? I am very sorry, I mistook you for something else.
曲娘: 哎呀，这……嘴巴娘子，你别生气，真不好意思，是我错认了。

The girl hunches over, clasping her hands together as she offers her apologies.
与先前不同，知错的小姑娘讷讷起来，缩着肩膀双手合十。

Jiu Niangzi: I'm going to get this rice paste off you. It's gotten all over your back ...
曲娘: 我这就给你把饭黏子拿下来，它都糊在你背上了……

Jiǔ Niángzǐ moves closer to the paper, observing it carefully.
曲娘凑近了信纸，仔细分辨。

But the paste is stuck firmly, so that despite her efforts, she can't remove it.
但是饭粒粘得太过牢固，她试了很多次，依然没有成功。

Jiu Niangzi: Umm ...
曲娘: 呃……

Pandora Wilson: ...
白雪松: ……

Jiu Niangzi: ... Ms. Mouth, please let me wipe you clean.
曲娘: ……嘴巴娘子，我给你擦擦吧，多少能干净些。

She is sorry about her recklessness.
自知理亏的冒失鬼。

Pandora Wilson: With that dirty, dripping rag you're holding?
白雪松: 用你手上那块滴着水的脏抹布吗?

The letter rejects her offer "viciously."
加上不领情的坏人。

Pandora Wilson: I suggest you stop now, before you make things any worse.
白雪松: 在事情变得更不可控制之前，我建议你立刻停止。

This is going to be a very special interview.
这会是一场无比特殊的采访。

The mouth takes a deep breath, trying to ignore the awkward stickiness that now permeated the paper.
白雪松深吸一口气，试图忽视背后黏腻的触感。

Pandora Wilson: How about we start with where these letters came from?
白雪松： 不如来谈谈这些信的来历吧。

Pandora Wilson: Most of them seem packed with useless words, lacking in any originality. Even at their most sincere, it's all superficial, unable to achieve anything more than empty flattery.
白雪松： 它们大多堆砌辞藻、重复率极高、缺乏新意。即使有几分真情实意，但大多也构建在轻浮之上，连基本的诚实都无法做到。

Pandora Wilson: These hardly seem like treasures worth keeping. They may be poems in the technical sense, but they're far from art.
白雪松： 这不是值得收藏的藏品，它们有“诗歌”的表象，却难以被称为艺术。

Pandora Wilson: So, why would you collect them?
白雪松： 你为何要收集它们?

Jiu Niangzi: You don't think of them as art ...?
曲娘： 不能被称为艺术……?

Jiu Niangzi: Ms. Mouth, truthfully, I don't understand much about art or collecting. It all seems like something rich gentlemen enjoy doing ... Gathering words or paintings and locking them away in a room.
曲娘： 哎呀，嘴巴娘子，其实艺术、收藏什么的，我也不明白，这不是有钱老爷们才喜欢做的事儿吗? 弄一些字呀、画呀，放在一个房间里，那样……

Jiu Niangzi: But these poems were all written for me. So, naturally, I kept them.
曲娘： 这些诗好歹是书生们写了，又交给我的，我自然就留着了。

Pandora Wilson: I suppose collecting personal letters could be called a hobby, if nothing else.
白雪松： 收藏亲手信的确是一种嗜好。

Pandora Wilson: I once knew a beautiful actress who hired out an entire office just to store all the love letters she received from her admirers. She said the letters always made her feel better in times of pain and stress.
白雪松： 我曾见过一位貌美的女演员，她租用了一个文件管理办公室来存放自己所有爱慕者的来信，只因为她在痛苦和倍感压力时，这些信总会令她感到满足。

Pandora Wilson: So ... do you enjoy reading these letters? Perhaps, reading all their flattery gives you a bit of vain pleasure.
白雪松： 那么……阅读这些信件对你来说是一种享受吗？你为此感到虚荣的快乐吗?

Glancing from the letters on the wall to the talking letter in front of her, Jiǔ Niángzǐ smiles knowingly.
瞧一瞧墙上的信，又看一看面前的白雪松，曲娘咧嘴一笑。

Jiu Niangzi: Haha, you've got it all wrong, miss. I don't even know what these letters say ... I can't read.
曲娘： 哈哈，娘子你说笑了，我都不识字，怎么能看懂这些信呢?

Pandora Wilson: So you ...?
白雪松： 那你……?

Jiu Niangzi: As far as I know, these are just thank you letters.
曲娘： 这都是大家给我的感谢信呀，我给他们帮了忙，他们谢谢我！而我怎么能糟蹋大家的感谢呢?

Jiu Niangzi: Of course, some letters could be praising my excellent liquor. I heard a scholar read one to me. It was all about "intoxicating this, intoxicating that" ...
曲娘： 当然，这之中一定也有称赞我的酒酿得好的信，我听一个书生念过，写的都是醉人不醉人什么的～

Jiu Niangzi: I'm glad so many people enjoy my liquor, when I get to serve them, I feel as if I'm a Xiángruì descending to bless the masses!
曲娘：大家喝了酒都开心，就像是祥瑞降世，赐福万千一样幸福快乐！

Pandora Wilson: "Xiángruì" ...? I've never heard this word before. What does it mean?
白雪松：“祥瑞”……？我从未听过这个词汇，它是什么意思？

Jiu Niangzi: It's a long story, miss. Here, let's take a seat—
曲娘：这可就说来话长了，娘子，请坐吧——

Jiǔ Niángzǐ sits on the veranda, spreads out the hem of her coat, and lays the letter on her lap.
曲娘坐在廊下，铺开衣摆，将信纸放在膝上。

Hesitating at first, she strokes the back of the paper, attempting to gently remove the sticky globs of rice.
她有些不甘心，依然轻轻地拨弄着信纸后头，试图撕开那团黏糊糊的米。

Jiu Niangzi: "Xiángruì" is an auspicious sign ... They bring good luck whenever they appear.
曲娘：“祥瑞”是吉祥的征兆……它们只要出现，就会带来好的运气。

Jiu Niangzi: Some are horses, some are deer, some are turtles, and others birds ...
曲娘：它们有的是马，有的是鹿，有的是乌龟，还有的是鸟……

Jiu Niangzi: Ms. Mouth, you can also be a Xiángruì, if you bring good luck to others!
曲娘：嘴巴娘子，如果你能给人带来好运，你也会是“祥瑞”呢！

Jiu Niangzi: Then everyone would be clamoring to write to you and profess their love for you and even pray to you for their good fortune!
曲娘：大伙会争着抢着给你写信，爱戴你，信仰你，以祈求这些好运气呢！

Pandora Wilson: For ease of communication, am I right to understand that these "Xiángruì" are a type of non-human Arcanists, or Arcane animals?
白雪松：为了沟通上的方便，我先将“祥瑞”理解为一种非人型的大型神秘学家，或者神秘动物。

The paper unfolds. The words appear on its inner layer.
信纸展开，记录文字浮现在内层。

Pandora Wilson: There are people here that write letters to Arcanists and pray to them for good luck ... Even venerating and exalting them like gods or spirits ...
白雪松：而有人向神秘学家写信，并且祈求好运……甚至崇敬、推举它们……

Pandora Wilson: I never imagined it would be like this in the East.
白雪松：我从未想象过，在东方会是这么一副光景。

Jiu Niangzi: The East? ... Ms. Mouth, are you from the West?
曲娘：东方？……嘴巴娘子，你是从西方来吗？

Pandora Wilson: Yes, I am from the West, a land far from here.
白雪松：是的，我从西方来，也从西方文化中出生。

Pandora Wilson: I came here to investigate a new kind of art that has emerged in this land and to showcase it.
白雪松：我来到这里，是为了目睹这块土地上诞生了什么样的艺术品，并且将其展现出来。

Jiu Niangzi: Oh, I've heard of this. I know a scholar who writes this kind of thing—he says it's, it's—a local chronicle!
曲娘：哎，这个我知道，我认识一个书生也是写这种东西的——他说这是、是——风土志！

Jiu Niangzi: It's a book that specifically records the customs, traditions, and geography of a place. If someone reads this book, even without leaving home, they might come to learn about interesting things that are happening miles away!
曲娘：是专门记录一片地方的风俗习惯、人情世故、山川地势的书籍，别人看了这书，即使足不出户，也可以知道千里之外的趣事！

Pandora Wilson: ...
白雪松：……

The red lips on the paper twitch slightly.
信纸上的红唇轻微地抽动了一下。

Pandora Wilson: Indeed, my publication is a sort of "local chronicle." You're quite right.
白雪松：的确如此，我所出版的刊物称得上为一本“风土志”。你说得并没有错。

Pandora Wilson: Most of our readers are on the other side of the world, in the West.
白雪松：它的大部分读者都在世界的另一侧，在西方。

Pandora Wilson: There was also a period of Arcane mania there, when people exalted Arcanists and relied on their divination and guidance.
白雪松：那里也曾有过神秘学狂热时期，人们推举过神秘学家，依靠他们的占卜和指引生活。

Pandora Wilson: But that's in the distant past, and Arcanist culture has been on a downward spiral since the witch hunts.
白雪松：但那已经是遥远的过去，自猎巫运动之后，神秘学家文化便开始了下行。

Pandora Wilson: Now, they've taken to the stage once more, but much of what they do is still behind the scenes. On the one hand, they have been thoroughly integrated into our scientific understanding of nature. But they've also been stripped of the mystery of the Arcane, so they're no longer revered. They're neither above nor below humans, a kind of neutral state.
白雪松：而如今，他们再次来到台前幕后，他们不上也不下，中性地存在着，被充分地使用，与科学相结合，失去其中神秘的遮挡，也再不被敬仰。

Jiu Niangzi: Are you saying that the West has no more faith? Do you not have deities or temples?
曲娘：你是说，西方没有神仙吗？也没有庙宇？

Pandora Wilson: No, many still have faith, but faith is faith. In the West, Humans and Arcanists often revere different gods.
白雪松：不，他们仍有信仰，但信仰是信仰。人类与神秘学家，大多也敬仰不同的神。

Jiu Niangzi: Does it need to be so divided?
曲娘：这需要分得那样清楚吗？

The girl's face wrinkles, her nose twitching slightly. She looks like she is thinking hard.
姑娘的脸皱巴巴地缩起来，鼻尖轻轻地抽动着，一副思考困难的模样。

Jiu Niangzi: A god is a god. As long as they give out their blessings, isn't that enough to believe in?
曲娘：只要是神，只要管用，不就好了？

Pandora Wilson: That might be so, miss.
白雪松：这就是个中差距了，小姐。

The paper gently pats her, wiping the grimace away.
Then it rises gracefully, drifting back and forth through the courtyard, as the voice murmurs to herself.
信纸轻轻地拍在她脸上，阻止了狰狞的表情。
紧接着她顺风而起，在庭院中左右飘荡，喃喃自语。

Pandora Wilson: However, some sort of difference does exist.
白雪松：但是，差异的确存在。

Pandora Wilson: Though a Human and an Arcanist might appear similar, there is indeed a gap in their underlying essence.
白雪松：尽管大体构成相似，但其底层逻辑确有差距。

Pandora Wilson: It's like the difference between ceramics and fiberglass, or silk and cotton.
白雪松：就像是陶瓷与玻璃的差别，就像是丝绸与棉麻布的差异。

Jiu Niangzi: So why does this difference exist? And when did it start to exist?
曲娘：那这差异为什么会存在？又是什么时候开始存在的呢？

Pandora Wilson looks at Jiǔ Niángzǐ. She blinks her eyes in response, with round pupils like dark purple grapes.
白雪松看向曲娘子，她眨着眼睛，两颗圆润的瞳孔如同紫黑色葡萄。

Jiu Niangzi: ...
曲娘：……

Pandora Wilson: What do you think about this question?
白雪松：这个问题，你自己是如何认为的?

Jiu Niangzi: ... Me?
曲娘：……我?

Jiu Niangzi: I'm asking you because I don't understand, Miss Mouth.
曲娘：我就是不懂才要来问你的呀，嘴巴娘子。

She holds her face in an exasperated show of innocence.
她托着脸，一派的天真。

Jiu Niangzi: I don't really understand what you're saying. There are many words that you speak that are unfamiliar to me.
曲娘：我听不懂你说的话，那太难了，有好多我听不明白的词，也不知道你说的这些东西都是些什么。

Stretching out her fingers, Jiǔ Niángzǐ puts them down one by one with each new thing she says.
伸出五指，一个个比划着，每说一个新东西，曲娘就掰下去一根。

Jiu Niangzi: Is fiberglass ... a kind of glass? I do know of silk, but it is a material that only certain officials can wear.
曲娘：玻璃……是琉璃的一种吗？丝绸我倒是知道，但也是只有达官贵人才能穿的料子。

Jiu Niangzi: I haven't even seen many of these things before, let alone compared them.
曲娘：这些东西我见都没见过，更别说比较了。

All ten fingers lay into her palms, turning them into two rounded fists. She flings them forward, lashing out at the night air.
十个手指全卧进了掌心，变成两个圆润的拳头，她只是向前一送，扑扑地打进夜风里。

Jiu Niangzi: Miss Mouth, you're different. You aren't me. I've never been anywhere. But you've seen all there is in the West, and now you've come to the East.
曲娘：可嘴巴娘子你不一样，你不是我，我哪儿也没去过，而你见过西方，也来过东方。

Jiu Niangzi: Comparing differences and looking for their cause is something only you can do. That's why I'm asking you!
曲娘：对比差距，寻找根本，想必是只有你才能做成的事儿了，所以我才来问你的！

Pandora Wilson: ... Indeed.
白雪松：……原来如此。

The paper folds itself again. Her voice softened considerably.
信纸重新收折在一起。她的声音似乎柔和了不少。

Pandora Wilson: You make an excellent point.
白雪松： 你的建议很好，我会采纳的。

Jiu Niangzi: Great! Then I suggest you leave first thing in the morning and take a look around the area. We're in the merchant's hub!
曲娘： 那太好了！我建议你明天一早就从我这儿出门，在附近转转，这里是金市！

Jiu Niangzi: It can get very lively around here. And even if you don't discover what you're looking for, it may still be good to go out and just have fun! What could be wrong with that?
曲娘： 人多，也热闹，更有趣！而且就算得不到什么结果，去玩一趟，也是好的！横竖不吃亏！

Jiu Niangzi: Oh—and one more thing!
曲娘： 哦——对了！

Jiǔ Niángzǐ stands, patting her now numb knees, and walks towards Pandora Wilson with intent.
曲娘站起身子，拍了拍麻痹的膝盖，快步走向白雪松。

Then she delicately takes the paper in her hands.
她的双手轻轻地、轻轻地牵住了信纸的两个边角。

Jiu Niangzi: It was wrong of me to stick a guest on the wall.
曲娘： 把客人粘在墙上，是我的错处。

Jiu Niangzi: It was also wrong of me to assume you were a silly love poem.
曲娘： 不问青红皂白就觉得你是情诗，也是我的错处。

Her words are true and sincere, and her small, tense face shines in the moonlight—
她言辞真挚、诚恳，一张小脸绷得紧紧的，在月色下照着——

The corners of the letter have been pulled and are difficult to refold. The sticky rice paste and crumpled paper proved impossible to hide in the moonlight.
信纸两角被拉扯着也难以遮挡。半黏着米糊、半被揉得发皱的纸张也被月亮照得明晰可见。

Jiu Niangzi: It ... was also wrong of me ... to pick at your paper ...
曲娘： 抠……抠坏了你的信纸，也……也是我的错处……

Pandora Wilson: ...
白雪松： ……

Pandora Wilson: .....
白雪松： ……

Jiu Niangzi: So I must humbly offer to cover your accommodation and all expenses during your stay in Pèi City!
曲娘： 我——我——我！我愿意负担你在沛城期间的住宿和所有消费！

Jiu Niangzi: Of course, if you can find the answer to your questions, please tell me ... It would be wonderful to know ...
曲娘： 当然，如果你能找到问题的答案，再告诉我……那、那就更好不过了……

《幽魂杂谈》
A Ghost Story Collection COL-400603

Pandora Wilson: What a generous girl. One could call her endearing simplicity "cute."
白雪松： 多么慷慨的小姐。她身上愚钝的可爱亦可称之为一种可爱。

Pandora Wilson: ... As long as that cuteness doesn't get taken out on me.
白雪松： ……只是那些可爱，不必发作在我身上。

Pandora Wilson: Anyway, I accepted her offer of hospitality and money. It was only right.
白雪松： 无论如何，我接受了她提供的栖身之所与金钱。这是我应得的。

Peddler I: My golden elixirs bring wealth and dispel disaster! Enlighten your mind! Are you after my lucky charms, or miracle remedies?
城中商贩 Ⅰ： 金丹妙药，旺财消灾！醍醐醒脑！傅符胡药，百试百灵！

Peddler II: Come one, come all! Witness this extraordinary lucky cabbage! A superior produce harvested only once every three years near the Wénqǔxīng Temple ...
城中商贩 Ⅱ： 诸位！这青叶菜非比寻常，乃是文曲星庙边三年一茬的上等佳品……

Peddler I: Face and bone painting, sketches and drawings. Come and see!
城中商贩 Ⅰ： 画皮画骨、描形绘状，走一走，瞧一瞧！

The peddler's calls and shouts echo back and forth, with shelves on both sides of the street filled with colorful goods.
商贩的吆喝声、叫卖声此起彼伏，街道两边的货架上摆满了五光十色的商品。

Pedestrians dressed in a motley of colors bustle around in an endless stream.
行人们穿着各色衣装，熙熙攘攘，川流不息。

Peddler I: Madam! Madam! Wait a moment!
城中商贩 Ⅰ： 娘子！娘子！且慢！

The peddler's face is painted with a wide, ever-bright smile. A pair of fox ears poke out from his hat, and orange and black fur grow on either side of his cheeks.
揽客的商贩笑脸灿烂，一对狐狸耳从帽檐旁呲出来，脸颊两侧也生着橘色与黑色的软毛。

Pandora Wilson: I don't need anything.
白雪松： 我没有购物的需求。

Peddler I: Oh, but why rush off, madam! It couldn't hurt to take a look, it won't cost you a thing—
城中商贩 Ⅰ： 哎呀，别着急走啊，娘子！只瞧一瞧，不会少块肉的——

The peddler pushes out a small wooden cart festooned with talismans and containers full of pills. But these are not what attract the most attention.
摊贩推着个小木车，上头摆放着不少丹药符纸。但最引人瞩目的不是这些。

A wooden stick is inserted in the stall, on which a white cloth is suspended, like a waving flag. Three large characters are scrawled in vermilion ink.
摊上插着一根木棍，木棍上悬挂白布，像是一面招摇旗帜，朱砂红墨洋洋洒洒地落下三个大字。

Pandora Wilson: ... "Face Painting"?
白雪松： ……“画皮术”?

Peddler I: Yes, madam. Face painting, that is exactly what that is!
城中商贩 Ⅰ： 是哩，娘子，正是画皮术！

Peddler I: Looking at you, I see only lips on your face. Pretty lips, of course, but you have no nose or eyes at all.
城中商贩 Ⅰ： 我见您这面上仅有一唇，没有鼻子，眼睛更是一只也无。

Peddler I: And if you have no nose, you must not be able to smell sweet perfumes. And if you have no eyes, you cannot see the beauty of the world. Not to mention ears and eyebrows!
城中商贩 I： 如若无鼻，便不能嗅百味，而无目，又不可观天地。更别说两只耳朵、两条眉毛了！

Peddler I: Sounds like a hard life? How could it not be dull?
城中商贩 I： 如此生活，怎能不困难？怎能不乏味？

Pandora Wilson: So, you want to draw the rest of my face for me?
白雪松： 按你的话说，你想为我画上其他五官？

Peddler I: Certainly! I will use a secret skin painting method to paint you, so that you will live a life of elegance and tranquility from now on. You'll be envied by even the immortals!
城中商贩 I： 当然了！我使这一门画皮秘法，给您画齐全立整，您从此活得快乐潇洒，神仙都羡慕！

What is there to be gained from interviewing a businessman? Or rather, what would it cost?
采访一个商人能得到什么？或者，需要付出什么？

The paper stretches into an approximation of a smile.
信纸舒展，约摸着是露出了一个笑容。

Pandora Wilson: ... As it happens, I have some silver with me.
白雪松： ……恰巧，我随身带了一些银钱。

Pandora Wilson: But can your painting technique be trusted?
白雪松： 你的绘画技巧可以信任吗？

Peddler I: Of course! My art is a product of generations, a business passed down my family line. I've been painting since I was a child—
城中商贩 I： 那当然了！我家里都是干这一行的，我可是从小就学着画画呢——

Peddler I: Should the painting not be to your satisfaction, come find me and I will fix it for you. Just make sure not to get it wet for seven days after painting ...
城中商贩 I： 画得若是不精、不美，您自可来寻我，我一定为您解决，只是注意，画完后七日不可沾水……

He flicks his fluffy ears, and his hat nearly floats off his head.
两只毛茸茸的耳朵一抖，几乎要把帽子顶得从头上浮起来。

Peddler I: Oh, enough about that, we'll talk about it later. First, you'll have to choose a style!
城中商贩 I： 哎呀，罢了罢了，这些后面慢慢说，您还是先选选款式吧！

Peddler I: Here, take a look. Which one do you want?
城中商贩 I： 来，您看看，想要什么样的？

The peddler eagerly hands over a picture album, flipping it open to reveal countless eyes of different shapes.
商贩殷切地递上画册，一翻开便是无数双形式不同的眼。

Peddler I: Please take a look. I have all the most current styles!
城中商贩 I： 您可以看看这本画册，时下流行的样式，我这儿应有尽有！

Peddler I: Of course, this pair at the very top is our bestseller! Everyone loves it!
城中商贩 I： 当然了，这最顶上的一双，是最畅销的！人人都喜欢！

Pandora Wilson: Best-selling eyes?
白雪松： 畅销的眼睛？

A pair of dark, shimmering eyes are drawn on the paper. There are indeed beautiful, but not outstanding.
一双黝黑闪烁的眼画在纸上，的确漂亮，但不足出彩。

Pandora Wilson: Are these "best-selling eyes" popular for purely aesthetic reasons, or is there something else?
白雪松： 这双眼睛之所以畅销，是出于单纯的美观考虑，还是另有原因?

Peddler I: Haha ... Naturally, take a look at the eyes—delicately shaped, an average length on the top and bottom, and black as ink.
城中商贩 I： 哈哈……您看这双眼睛，颇似雁子的眼睛——形状清秀，上下都是一般长，又兼之黑如点漆。

Peddler I: In our profession, these are called "Goose Eyes." Another name for them is "eyes of righteousness."
城中商贩 I： 按我们行内的话来说，这叫“雁目”，另有一别称，乃是“义气蕴玉之眼”。

Peddler I: Goose Eyes not only have a pleasing shape and a good name but also excellent symbolism.
城中商贩 I： 这雁眼，不光形貌悦目，名头好听，还有一个极佳的寓意。

Peddler I: According to physiognomy, if a person has Goose Eyes, they are modest and courteous, have a measured temperament, and will be rich and prosperous.
城中商贩 I： 相学上说，人若有雁目，则谦恭有礼，气度有量，又能富贵发达。

Peddler I: Miss Mouth, may I say you would look fabulous with Goose Eyes.
城中商贩 I： 嘴巴娘子，您若是能添一双雁眼，定是极好看的。

Peddler I: Now, about your nose ...
城中商贩 I： 再说这鼻……

Citizen: Tsk! You itinerant con-man, not surprised to see you still swaggering about!
居民： 呔！好你个江湖骗子，这时候还在招摇撞骗！

With a loud shout, the bustling street falls silent for a few seconds. Everyone stares blankly at the newcomer.
一声暴呵，繁闹的街头都被唬得静了几秒，只是愣愣望向来人。

The newcomer has a black cloth with two holes in it tied around their head.
而那来人，头蒙黑布，唯有两处挖了孔洞。

One hole is where a person's forehead should be, and the other is on his cheekbone. And two angry red eyes peer out from them.
一处位于常人的额际上，另一处位于常人的颧骨处。而两个洞中，都能瞧见气得发红的眼。

Citizen: Four days ago, I spent a small fortune on your so-called face painting. And it all seemed fine at first.
居民： 四日前，我自你这儿花了大钱画的面皮，刚画完的时候还好好的。

Citizen: But now, look at me! It's left my eyes, nose, and mouth all askew!
居民： 如今半点作用不见，反将我这眼鼻口弄得东倒西歪！

Citizen: Whenever I go out, I have to cover my face because of you—you owe me an explanation!
居民： 出门经行，还得用黑布覆面——你得给个说法！

He furiously pushes aside the letter, grabs the fox-eared peddler by his clothes and begins to shake him.
他气势汹汹，一把推开白雪松，扯住狐耳朵商贩的衣襟，用力撕扯摇晃。

The cloth sinks slightly inward in the middle of his face, rising and falling with the sound of each frenzied breath, making it clear that the place where his nose should have been is now his mouth.
言语之间，鼻子处不似常人隆起，反而微微陷下，随着气息一张一吸——想来正是嘴巴。

Peddler I: This ...!
城中商贩 I： 这……！

Peddler I: Oh, sir, this—this is obviously because the paint got wet— that's what ruined everything!
城中商贩 I： 哎呀，客官，您这——这明显就是面皮沾了水——才坏了事儿呀！

Peddler I: Was I not clear when we made the deal? Hmm? So why are you coming to me with complaints now?!
城中商贩 I： 我们买卖时说得清楚，怎么现在倒来寻我的错处了呢！

In their struggle, the peddler's hat flows off, his collar opens, and the contents of the stall are scattered all over the ground.
撕扯之间，帽子飞了去，领口豁了开，摊子上的东西也撒了满地。

The peddler's tail stiffens, and his ears press tightly against his scalp, but he can't match the man's strength. He can only shout at the top of his lungs.
商贩气得尾巴僵直，耳朵紧绷绷地贴着头皮，但力气抵不过男人，只好扯着嗓子喊叫起来。

Peddler I: You—you're extorting me! Help, help!
城中商贩 I： 你——你这是讹诈！讹人！

Citizen: You aren't conning your way out of this!
居民： 还敢狡辩！

Citizen: I ought to teach you a lesson today, you crooked businessman!
居民： 我今天非得给你这个奸商点颜色看看！

As the pair are at loggerheads, an elderly man sweeps aside the crowd and stands between the two.
剑拔弩张之时，一位年迈的长者拂开人群，站在了两人之间。

Lizheng: What has caused all of this commotion?
里正： 这是怎么回事?

Lǐzhèng's arrival effects an immediate hushed silence.
里正的到来，使四周短暂地静谧了一瞬。

Followed soon after by, an even bigger ruckus—as the peddler and the man begin to argue over one another.
随后迎来了更大的喧闹——商贩与男子各执一词，七嘴八舌地吵将起来。

Lizheng: Quiet—quiet!
里正： 安静——安静！

Lǐzhèng examines the man with the crooked mouth and eyes.
里正看向那名口眼歪斜的男子。

Lizheng: State your case.
里正： 你先说。

Citizen: Lǐzhèng, sir, four days ago, I let this crooked businessman paint my face. I only wanted to make myself look a little more presentable, then maybe I wouldn't scare away the ladies ...
居民： 里正大人，四日前，我让这奸商画了面皮，原本想让容貌端正些，不再吓到那位卖符纸的娘子。

Citizen: But then after I washed my face, my entire face went crooked!
居民： 结果我一洗漱，就弄得鼻歪眼斜！

Lǐzhèng then looks towards the fox-eared peddler and gestures for him to speak.
里正再看向生着狐狸长耳的商贩，示意他开口说话。

Lizheng: Your turn.
里正： 好，你再说。

Peddler I: Sir, please understand ... To be effective, my miraculous method of face painting requires my clients to go seven days without washing or wetting the paint.
城中商贩 I： 大人明鉴……我那画皮妙方，需得经由七日不洗不漱，方才生效。

Peddler I: I made this very clear during the transaction. But only four days have passed, and as the man himself said, he has washed his face!
城中商贩 I： 买卖时俱是说得清楚明白，如今才过了四日，且这样子，定是沾了水的……

Peddler I: If it did get wet, then his face would return to normal after seven days. As for its current crookedness, there's nothing I can do. He'll just have to cover it up.
城中商贩 I： 而且就算沾了水，在七日后，也可以发挥效用，只是这几日肯定是口眼歪斜、不能见人……

The more he says, the more aggravated he feels. The peddler purses his lips.
越说越是委屈，小贩扁起嘴来。

Lizheng: In that case, the answer is quite simple.
里正： 既然如此，倒也简单。

Lizheng: You, sir, must wait for three more days. If your face remains dissatisfactory after three days, then the peddler will have to find some way to restore your previous appearance.
里正： 这位买主，你且再等上三日，若三日后还是不成，这商贩便需给你恢复到之前的面容。

Citizen: Lǐzhèng, sir, you have my greatest admiration. But this deceitful merchant is clearly incompetent, how can I trust his word that my features won't stay distorted?
居民： 里正大人，我向来敬仰您。可这奸商若是没本事，我这五官不还是得东倒西歪的……

Citizen: When it comes to casting spells or seeking medical treatment, timing is critical. A day or two is manageable, but if too much time passes, I could be stuck like this forever. I ... I won't be able to live!
居民： 符咒施法也好，看医治病也好，最重要的就是时机，一天两天还好，如果耽误了时候，我一辈子都这副模样，我实在……实在是要活不成了呀！

The burly man covers his face with his hands and lets out a pitiful whimper.
身形壮硕的汉子用手掩面，可怜兮兮起来，倒有几声呜咽意思。

Citizen: It's bad enough that people think I look like a joke ... But with this face even eating becomes an unbearable hassle!
居民： 常人看着我这样貌，只当是好笑……但一旦变成了这样，饮食起居，都是说不尽的麻烦！

Citizen: A mouthful of rice winds up either in my eyes or up my nose ... Once I finally get it in my mouth, it makes my head spin all over again ...!
居民： 一口饭，要么吃到眼睛里，要么喂到鼻子里……好不容易咽到嘴里，又、又是满头转圈……！

Peddler I: Fine ... Sir, if you don't trust me, let's go and find Ms. Fù.
城中商贩 I： 这……客官，您若是信不过我，不如和我去找傅娘子。

Peddler I: Ms. Fù's red talismans are renowned throughout the land. She will surely have a solution to our mutual problem. And as lucky would have, we're well-acquainted, she will certainly grant my request ...
城中商贩 I： 傅娘子画的丹砂符，十里八乡都是出了名的，这问题她肯定有解法，而她和我相熟，我拜托她，自然是能成的……

Citizen: Ms—Ms. Fù?! You awful fox, you're talking nonsense again!
居民： 傅——傅娘子?！你这狐狸，又在编瞎话了！

The man's askew face suddenly flushes, his neck reddening along with it.
男子歪斜的脸腾的一下，连带着脖子一起红起来。

Peddler I: Sir, I'm nothing if not an honest businessman. I've never swindled a soul.
城中商贩 I： 先生，我是老实商人，从不诓骗。

Peddler I: Haven't you heard of Hú Fù's Emporium? I've done very good business with Ms. Fù. We wouldn't lie to you about something like this.
城中商贩 I： 难道你没听说过胡傅铺子吗？我和傅娘子的生意，老主顾多得是，不至于为了这事儿扯谎呀。

Citizen: Hú ... Hú ... Oh! Your last name is Hú—
居民： 胡……胡……呀！你便是那个姓胡的——

His eyes widen and blink repeatedly, his crooked mouth opening and closing.
竖起来的眼睛眨了又眨，歪到一侧的嘴巴张张合合。

The man stomps his feet, dropping a bag of broken silver. He cries out "Forget it," and turns away hurriedly.
男子砰砰跺脚，丢下一袋碎银，连声喊着罢了罢了，匆忙地转身离去。

The peddler, who has looked sad just a moment before, smiles. With sharp eyes and nimble fingers, he slips the money bag into his pocket.
而商贩方才还愁苦的脸笑着，眼疾手快地将钱袋揣进怀中。

Peddler I: Right, with all that finished. Where was that lovely-lipped customer? I can't let all this trouble keep me from making money ...
城中商贩 I： 对啦，客人，我刚刚的客人呢，可别耽误了我赚钱……

The excitement dies down, and the crowd of onlookers eventually disperses.
热闹平了，围观的人群自然就此散去。

The peddler's ears prick up, and he looks from side to side. At last, he catches sight of the fluttering white sheet. She is already far down the road, followed by Lǐzhèng, who is dressed in green.
商贩竖着耳朵左右顾盼，终于瞧见那一抹飘摇的白色，她已经行至远处，身旁跟着青衣的里正。

Pandora Wilson: You said the Hú and Fù families have been in business together for nearly ten years in this city?
白雪松： 如你所说，胡、傅两家一起经商，在这个城中已经有近十年了？

Lizheng: Yes. Though, the story of the Hú and Fù families started a few generations ago.
里正： 是了，这胡、傅两家的事，还得从几代之前开始说。

Lizheng: In the beginning, the Hú family came down from the mountains to the city. They were fox spirits and tricksters. When they saw two adjacent houses that they liked, they decided to move in.
里正： 最初，胡家从山中进城，见到两处相邻屋宅合乎心意，便就此住了进去。

Lizheng: The owner of those houses was a wealthy merchant who would often be away on business during the year. After the Hú moved in, they began to torment his wife and children. It got so bad that they moved out within just three months.
里正： 原本的户主是个富商，常年不在家中，妻儿老小被狐狸一家折腾得不轻，不出三个月就搬家离去。

Lizheng: Once the merchant returned, he tried selling the property, but anyone who tried to buy it was quickly driven away by the foxes' tricks. Over time, everyone knew to avoid the houses, so all his buyers dried up.
里正： 商人不是没想过卖掉这处房产，可想接手看宅的人全被狐狸耍花招赶了去，时间一长，人人知道这屋子闹妖，自然没人愿意买了。

Pandora Wilson: So the foxes ... No, the Hú family ... just lived there?
白雪松： 所以狐狸……不，胡家人，就这么住在里面了？

Pandora Wilson: Isn't that illegal? Why didn't the city's management intervene?
白雪松： 这是不正当的，城中的管理力量没有介入这件事吗？

Lizheng: At the time ...
里正：那时啊……

Lǐzhèng looks up at the sky, pondering for a moment.
里正抬头望向天空，沉吟片刻。

Lizheng: Don't laugh, madam, but at that time, the management of Pèi City was very lax. Back then the leaders only cared for themselves and ignored the concerns of the people.
里正：不怕你笑话，娘子。那时候沛城管持松散，当值里正只知享乐，是不管民间这样的小事的。

Pandora Wilson: These things happen everywhere. It's hardly surprising.
白雪松：任何地方都有这样的事。不足为奇。

The paper trembles slightly, returning to the previous topic.
信纸轻微地摇晃一下，重新提出话头。

Pandora Wilson: So, did the Fù family take up residence there afterward?
白雪松：而后，傅书生来到了这处居所吗?

Lizheng: Yes. The Fù family was poor and had only a small straw house to live in. It also happened that the snow was heavy that winter and collapsed the roof of their house.
里正：是了，傅生家贫，只有一栋小草屋可住。又恰好冬日雪重，压塌了他家里的屋顶。

Lizheng: With no other family around, Mr. Fù and his wife had nowhere to go. In desperation, they decided to brave the haunted houses and its fox spirits.
里正：他父母皆去，带着妻子无处可投，终是想起了城中闹狐的宅邸。

Lizheng: Mr. Fù was a scholar and didn't make much money. What little he earned was from helping people write letters.
里正：他自己是做学问的，没什么赚钱的路子，只能帮人写些书信，赚些润笔费。

Lizheng: His wife's maiden name was Huò. She was born in Qiántáng and had something to do with Daoism. Her family fell out of power, but a few generations ago, some of them had transformed into immortals.
里正：而他的妻子霍氏出身钱塘，与道学有渊源，虽然家道中落，但家中几代之前也是有人尸解成仙的。

Lizheng: Unfortunately, she had few useful talents. She could paint, but not well. Her paintings were not worth much.
里正：只可惜她天分稀薄，虽会画符，但画得不好，也卖不出什么价钱。

Pandora Wilson: The Hú family were arcanists. And having lived so long deep in the mountains means their bloodline must have been very pure. Meanwhile, it sounds like the Huò family was much more deeply entrenched in the world, so their bloodline had thinned ... Was she a mixed-blooded arcanist?
白雪松：胡家为神秘学家，深居山中，自然血统纯粹。霍家虽入世颇深，但血脉稀薄……她是一位混血神秘学家吗?

Pandora Wilson: So, when the merchant abandoned this home, it turned into a struggle between these Arcanists?
白雪松：那归根结底，人类富商离去，故事仍旧变成了的神秘学家与神秘学家的斗争?

Lǐzhèng waves his hand, revealing a candid smile.
里正摆手，露出一个爽朗的笑容。

Lizheng: Not quite, madam. Let me explain it to you in detail.
里正：非也非也，娘子，你听我细细说来。

Lizheng: Let's start with the Hú and Huò families. They are pretty much as you said.
里正：先说胡家与霍家，他们与你想的并无差异。

Lizheng: The Hú family were originally fox spirits from the mountains, indeed they had their own domain there. Their marriages were restricted to their race. But this particular branch lost its power and land in some kind of squabble, so they were forced to come here to make a living.
里正：胡家本是山中狐仙，自有山头，嫁娶也论门当户对，他们这一旁支是夺权失利，在山里没了地方过日子，才下山来讨生活。

Lizheng: The Huò family, on the other hand, had a background in Daoism. They had long intermarried with spirits of plants and trees. But they always lived among humans, and their marriages were more open-minded.
里正：而霍家修道出身，也与草木精灵有过通婚，但从来都活在人中，婚嫁也更开明随意。

Lizheng: So, as you guessed, one side was the Arcanists, and the other was the Mixed.
里正：这两方一个是神秘学家，一个是神秘学家混血种。

Lizheng: But then there was also Mr. Fù in the house, as I mentioned.
里正：而宅子里除了胡霍，还有一个傅家人，也就是傅生。

Pandora Wilson: And I suspect that he was ...
白雪松：难道他是……

Lizheng: Yes, he is human.
里正：是了，他是个货真价实的“人”。

Lizheng: Mr. Fù's family was poor, and had no particular talents or abilities to speak of. There were no special restrictions on who they could marry, but most were ordinary humans. He was, as countless generations of his ancestors had been, thoroughly human.
里正：与霍氏祖上那样有点奇能异力的人不同，傅生家贫，通婚虽无筛选，但也都是无异能之家。他连带着自己那十八辈的祖宗，都是彻底的“人”。

Lizheng: As for Mr. Fù and Ms. Huò, they were deeply in love, a marriage as solid as gold; one a careful and smart planner, and the other able to cast spells.
They relied on their wits to contend with the foxes, as they squabbled back and forth.
里正：而后面的故事就简单得多了，傅霍夫妻两个情比金坚，你出计谋，我画符咒。
倒也靠着机智和狐狸斗法，有来有回，妙趣横生。

Lizheng: They had set up a trap for the foxes—to conjure up a green snake that would appear behind one of them. And it worked. It scared the eldest of the Hú family; when he saw that snake, they say, he jumped three feet into the air and fell with a splash into a nearby well.
里正：今日给狐狸画个陷阱，明日又在狐狸屁股后头变出一条绿纸捏的蛇，将那半夜困顿、化了原型出来喝水的胡家老大吓得一蹦三尺高，噗通一声落入了井中。

Pandora Wilson: And then?
白雪松：而后呢?

Lizheng: Haha, well the couple had heard the commotion. They came shouting and scrambling over the fence between the two houses, in order to rescue the old fox.
里正：而后，哈哈，傅家夫妇两个被这动静吓了一跳，大呼小叫地翻过篱笆墙来救狐。

Lizheng: Ms. Huò, feeling guilty for endangering someone's life, took her silver hairpin and used the Máoshān Art of Walking Through Walls to tunnel through the earth and reach the bottom of the well to fish out the old fox.
里正：霍氏心急害了他人性命，手握一根银钗，使着时灵时不灵的茅山穿墙术，硬是穿过土地钻到了井底，才将胡家老大捞了上来。

Lizheng: Unfortunately, the old fox still fell ill from all the shock and cold, and Ms. Huò drained by her use of such an unpredictable magic, fell sick as well.
里正：事后，胡家老大受惊又受冻，一下病倒在床。而霍氏施术劳累过度，也高烧不退。

Lizheng: So the Hú and Fù all nursed them back to health together; feeling indebted and grateful to one another, they somehow wound up becoming the closest of friends.
里正： 胡家小子、胡家妇人再加上一个傅生，三个人伺候完这头照顾那头，都有亏欠之意，也都有感恩之心。就此，反而成了好朋友。

Lizheng: After the two families reconciled, the wildness of the Hú family began to soften, and they learned much more about the world. After a few years, they even took it upon themselves to apologize to the merchant's family.
里正： 两家由此修好，互有往来。胡家野性渐驯，懂得了不少世俗道理，又过了几年，居然自己找上富商家登门道歉了。

Pandora Wilson: ...
白雪松： ……

The story draws to a close. The visitor from the West, thrilled from start to finish, is silent for a while before she asks another question.
故事落幕，开头惊险而结局圆满，西方的来客沉默许久，再提出一问。

Pandora Wilson: And that's how their relationship continues to be to this day?
白雪松： 他们的关系就这样持续到今天?

Lizheng: Indeed it is.
里正： 正是如此。

Pandora Wilson: A ... Pure-blooded human—
白雪松： 一个……纯血人类——

Pandora Wilson: Closely connected with an Arcanist and a Mixed-blood, almost... As close as family.
白雪松： 与神秘学家、神秘学家混血种，三方紧密相连，几乎……亲密如同一家人。

Pandora Wilson: Is there no conflict or estrangement between them?
白雪松： 他们之间，并无矛盾与隔阂产生吗?

Pandora Wilson: As you said, these Hú were hard to tame and had long plundered the residence. Did nobody care about all of their wrongdoings?
白雪松： 正如你说的，狐狸野性难驯，抢夺住宅，难道就无人在意他的过错吗?

Lizheng: Madam, a certain amount of conflict and injustice will always exist; they are as constant as the movement of the heavens or the falling of rain.
里正： 娘子，争斗与不平当然存在，甚至每时每刻都在发生。

Lǐzhèng halts. They have reached the end of the bustling merchant's hub. Looking back, it is full of merchants and crowds of pedestrians.
里正停下脚步，他们已经行至金市尽头，向后望去，商户繁多，行人密密。

Lizheng: The commotion you saw just now happens several times a day in this market.
里正： 方才那样的喧哗，这市集上一天就可见好几起。

Lizheng: With mortals, extraordinary men, mountain spirits, and even immortals ascending on their clouds, how could there be no friction or discord among them?
里正： 凡人、奇人、山精妖怪，哪怕是飞升踏云而去的神仙，他们之间怎会没有摩擦龃龉?

Lizheng: It's said there is friction between the extraordinary and the mundane and animosity between monsters and immortals, and do mortals not war against each other? Do extraordinary men not scheme against one another?
里正： 说是奇人与凡人有摩擦，妖怪与神仙相憎恨，但凡人与凡人就不征战吗？奇人和奇人就不相互陷害吗?

Lizheng: But if it is true that everyone can harm one another, why can't they love each other just as easily?
里正：既然大家都可互相戕害，为何不可互相爱戴?

Pandora Wilson: I understand what you mean.
白雪松：我明白你的意思了。

The writing on the paper has stopped, and the letter refolds itself.
笔迹停止，信纸将自己重新折叠。

Pandora Wilson: This has truly been an unbelievable story and a rare new display of art.
白雪松：这真是一个难以想象的故事，更是一种不可多得的全新的艺术展示。

Pandora Wilson: Thank you for sharing it with me, sir.
白雪松：很感谢你告诉我这些，老先生。

Lizheng: Haha ... You're welcome. Jiǔ Niángzǐ told me you were her guest, which makes you our guest. She has welcomed you, and so do we.
里正：哈哈……不必客气，曲娘和我说过，你是她的客人，便是我们的客人。她喜欢你，也敬重你，我们自然也一样。

Lizheng: I hope you might spend some more time with her. She never had any friends her age ...
里正：只期盼你多与她玩一玩，这孩子，从没有过什么适龄的朋友……

Gate Guard: Message!
城门郎：报——

Gate Guard: Greetings, Lǐzhèng! Mr. Fǎcáo has arrived. We were waiting for you to return to discuss how to deal with the mischievous birdman we seized!
城门郎：里正大人！法曹大人已到，正待您返回一同商议如何处置前日扣押的作乱鸟人！

Pandora Wilson: Birdman ...?
白雪松：鸟人……?

Pandora Wilson: What a coincidence. I, too, encountered a "birdman" gentleman not long ago. Lǐzhèng, could you arrange a meeting between us?
白雪松：很巧，我在不久之前也曾遇到过一位“鸟人”先生，不知里正是否可以安排我们会面?

Lizheng: Apologies, madam. But Zhící is not a place for idle chit-chat.
里正：抱歉，娘子。职祠并非玩乐之地，还是趁早打消这种念头为好。

Lǐzhèng nods a polite farewell. Walking away with the gate guard, they disappear at the end of the road.
里正点头告别，与城门郎相伴走远，消失在道路尽头。

As the letter returns to the merchant's hub, a girl in a green dress rushes past her in a hurry.
金市前头，一个穿绿裙的姑娘疾步快跑而来。

Young Girl: Cousin! Cousin, what's going on? Did you get into another argument? Did you pull their tail again?!
年轻姑娘：表哥！表哥，你是怎么回事，又和人吵起来了？是不是又给人家薅了尾巴去?!

Young Girl: I keep saying I should run the stand, but somehow I always let you win. Whenever you get into arguments, you come home shedding fur in patches with an upset stomach. Then we'll all have to listen to you howling through the night—
年轻姑娘：我早说了该我去叫卖，你只知道脾气好地让渡，每次被抓了尾巴耳朵，回家便是掉毛闹肚子，半夜凄凄嚎——

《魔精地理志》
Critter Geographics COL-400604

Getian: ...?
葛天：……?

There is a faint trembling sound, and a white light appears in the dim space.
细不可闻的震动之声先到，而后，幽暗空间中乍现一道白光。

A glimmer of silver flashes, accompanied by the jingle of bells, and a round hole suddenly appears on the wall.
一点银芒闪烁，伴随着环佩叮当，墙壁上拓出一个圆形的大洞。

Getian: Who—are you?
葛天：你——这是?

Pandora Wilson: "Is the Art of Walking Through Walls not marvelous?"
白雪松：“穿墙之术，不甚妙哉。”

Beneath the paper, a silver hairpin floats gently in front of Gětiān.
信纸下别着一支银钗，悠悠然来到葛天身前。

Pandora Wilson: Your prediction was correct, Mr. Gětiān. We meet again.
白雪松：你所预言的并没有错误，鸟人先生。我们又见面了。

Pandora Wilson: But why are you so surprised? Aren't you able to see the future?
白雪松：只是，你为何如此惊讶？你不是早已看见了未来吗?

Getian: I do not see the future. Not really ...
葛天：我并不能预见未来。

Gětiān closes his eyes and the hole in the wall closes.
葛天闭上双眼，墙壁上的洞穴已然并合。

Getian: My clan is called the "Mièméng." We are able to do Bone Readings and capable of changing fates.
葛天：我族名为“灭蒙鸟”，可识骨辨相，改命游方。

Getian: Your inquiring mind was evident as soon as I read your Features of Bones, and I knew you're not one to give up on your "interviews" easily. I hadn't avoided you on purpose. So it was only a matter of time for us to run into one another again.
葛天：我断言你与我还会相见，是预见你骨相中探知心重，且不轻易放弃。我只是一时忙乱，并无躲避你的意思，只要我们都还在城内，自然还能再见面。

Pandora Wilson: What did you mean by "Features of Bones"? Based on what you're saying, it seems to be ... a person's essence?
白雪松：“骨相”是什么？根据你的意思，它似乎是一个人的……某种本质?

Getian: You might say that.
葛天：你可以如此理解。

Getian: One's bones provide support. Beneath the skin lies flesh and blood; beneath flesh and blood lie tendons and veins. All are housed by the skeleton.
葛天：骨为支撑，皮之下为血肉，血肉下为筋脉，筋脉盘踞于骨架。

Getian: Beyond these chaotic, soft things, Features of Bones is the root of what we become. Understanding Features of Bones allows one to comprehend all things.
葛天：混沌的、柔软的东西之后，支撑与树立的根本，便是骨相。知得骨相，便可通晓万物。

The bird's wide wings folded, and the paper hovers over them.
鸟儿宽阔的翅膀蜷缩在一起，信纸悬停其上。

Pandora Wilson: So, you might say you are also an admirer of beauty.
白雪松：这么一说，你也是一位鉴赏家。

Pandora Wilson: I admire things through their fragrance note, their medium, their dimensions, and form. But you eschew the rest, and look straight to the structure beneath.
白雪松：我感知到的香气、介质、尺寸与形态，是我的鉴赏方式。而你摒弃其余，只凝视构架骨骼。

She examines the bird and places the silver hairpin before him.
她审视着面前巨大的鸟儿，将银钗置于他的面前。

Pandora Wilson: I happen to have a question that I'd like to discuss with a wise arcanist from the East who understands all things.
白雪松：我恰好有一个问题，愿意与来自东方、通晓万物的鉴赏者洽谈。

Getian: This pin is what allows you to "walk through walls" ...
葛天：这是，那支能够施展“穿墙术”的……

Pandora Wilson: Yes, it's a fantastic silver hairpin. Roughly crafted but interestingly shaped. It is also lightweight and easy to carry, making it a rare, high-quality wand.
白雪松：是的，一支神奇的银质头饰。它工艺粗糙，但造型风趣，轻巧便于携带，是支难得的好术杖。

Pandora Wilson: It came from Ms. Huò in the story, Ms. Fu's grandmother. She, in turn, had gotten the silver hairpin from her grandmother.
白雪松：它来自故事中的霍氏，傅娘子的祖母。而她，又是从自己的祖母手中拿到了这支银钗。

Pandora Wilson: It is worn by women in their family—mothers, wives, and daughters.
白雪松：它的主人是一个家族中的女性，母亲、妻子、女儿，都可佩戴。

Pandora Wilson: Thanks to intermarriage, it had been worn in the hair of Arcanists and Humans, of pure and of mixed blood.
白雪松：伴随通婚，它曾佩戴在纯血神秘学家、神秘学家混血种、人类混血种、纯血人类的发间。

Pandora Wilson: Some of its owners could use it, and wield its great power to save lives. Some couldn't, and with them it would rest peacefully, serving as only a decoration.
白雪松：有的主人能使用它，它便大显神通，救人性命。有的主人不能使用它，它便安然沉睡，用于装点。

Pandora Wilson: This seems to me to be the essence of the "East," a microcosm of different limitations.
白雪松：这是“东方”的根本，一切局限的缩影。

Pandora Wilson: And the "bones" you see in me come from a different "framework" the one that defines the West.
白雪松：而你在我身上所看见的“骨”，来自于西方的“框架”。

Pandora Wilson: I wonder, what do you think causes these differences between us?
白雪松：我想知道，你认为这其中差异是因何而生的呢?

Getian: What you really ask is, why do two trees grow different branches?
葛天：你想知道的是，两棵树为何长出了不同的枝丫?

Taking the silver hairpin, the tips of the wings cross to lift it up.
接过银钗，双翅的尖端交叠，将其捧起。

Getian: As the famous saying goes here, "Oranges grown south of the Huai River are true oranges; but if they are transplanted north of the river, they become acrid and bitter."
葛天：“橘生淮南则为橘，生于淮北则为枳。”

Getian: The same seed, sown in different places, will yield different fruit.
葛天：即使是同样的种子，播种在不同的地方，也会有不一样的结果。

Getian: It may have something to do with the way the seed was sown ... Or maybe with the rain, sun, wind, and dew. All of it is related.
葛天：也许这与播种方式相关……也许与雨水、阳光、风露，各有关联。

Getian: So why ask such a question? Do you perhaps long to go back in time and correct these two trees as they branch off in different directions?
葛天：你为何会问出这样的问题呢？你是渴盼着回到过去，在这两条枝丫走向不同的方向时修正它们吗？

Pandora Wilson: ... I have no such intention.
白雪松：……我并无此意。

Pandora Wilson: I'm just trying to record things as they are and find the answers to my questions.
白雪松：我只是想展现事情的原貌，为问题寻找一个答案。

Getian: You said you were an interviewer.
葛天：你曾说过，你是一名采访者。

Getian: Do your interviews seek definitive answers?
葛天：你的采访追寻的是明确的答案吗？

Pandora Wilson: No ... Of course not. UTTU is meant to show ideas, thoughts, and the true essence of things.
白雪松：不，当然……不是。《UTTU》应当展现想法、思想与真正的本质。

Pandora Wilson: It is meant to be a showcase, a pioneering consciousness. Not a textbook or a tool.
白雪松：它是先锋，是意识，而非教科书与工具。

Getian: That's what I see in you, Ms. Pandora Wilson.
葛天：这正是我从你身上看到的，白雪松小姐。

Getian: Focusing on these minutiae will lead you astray.
葛天：执迷于细枝末节的分析会让前路失去方向。

Gětiān takes a step forward, gently tossing the silver hairpin in his hand ahead of him. With a jingle, the tip of the hairpin strikes the wall squarely.
葛天前进一步，将手中银钗向前轻轻抛出，叮当一声，钗尖正中墙壁。

He has long known the incantation to open the hole.
而那洞开的口诀他早已知晓。

Getian: "Is the Art of Walking Through Walls not marvelous?"
葛天：“穿墙之术，不甚妙哉。”

Light reappears. Ms. Fù, who is waiting with a curious expression outside the walls of Zhící, tugs on her cousin's sleeve and shakes it vigorously.
光亮再现，职祠墙外一脸好奇等待着的傅娘子拽着表哥的袖子奋力摇晃。

Young Girl: Ms. Mouth's words really worked. She said she wanted to see the birdman, and her words got him to come out!
年轻姑娘：这嘴巴娘子说话果然管用，说给她见鸟人，便真把鸟人引了出来！

Getian: The walls of this place are like a prison. But if you have the skill to penetrate their walls, it is a small matter to escape.
葛天：墙壁高耸，身陷囹圄，若有穿墙之术，便可跳脱其中。

The blank white paper stands beside the hole in the wall, its crimson lips pursed slightly.
白茫茫的信纸站在洞开的墙壁旁，赤红的口在折皱中上下开合。

Pandora Wilson: Thank you for your wisdom.
白雪松： 多谢指点。

【1.6】赛季剧情 05

COL-400605

Storyteller: Last time we spoke—
说书先生： 上回说到——

Citizen VI: Lùshǔ the Xiángruì came to the human world to go through the god's test, but she repented!
城中居民 VI： 说到祥瑞鹿蜀人间历劫，幡然悔悟！

Storyteller: Exactly. She had been troubled by the repentance until the New Year's Eve. That night, her tutor straightened her out, and she was very grateful. After that, she bid him goodbye and went to the broken bridge alone.
说书先生： 正是。且说那鹿蜀，衔草结环，除夜叩拜了先生开解之恩，自城中一别，独往断桥去也。

Wooden Doll: **Ms. Mouth! Ms. Mouth!**
木头小人： **嘴巴娘子！嘴巴娘子！**

The candles are dim. The place is clearly deserted.
灯台昏暗，此处显然人去楼空。

As the paper floats into the room through the window, a wooden doll eagerly rushes up to it.
信纸从窗口飘入房间时，木头小人便急切地喳喳包围上来。

Pandora Wilson: Are you ... Ms. Jiǔ's arcane creation?
白雪松： 这是……九小姐的神秘术造物？

Wooden Doll: **A message, a message.**
木头小人： **留信，留信。**

The wooden doll jumps on a piece of paper.
木头小人在一张纸上跳了跳。

Pandora Wilson: ... I can't believe she couldn't even keep her promise to me.
白雪松： ……真难以想象，她甚至没能和我兑现她的承诺。

The tone is mocking, yet intimate. It has only been a few days she has stayed with her, but they have become quite familiar with each other.
语气揶揄，却又亲近。无论如何，几日同住让她们相熟不少。

The farewell letter left for Pandora is unfolded, with a crude drawing of a person carrying a package on the paper. The figure has a bun on its head with a liquor ladle sticking out from it.
为一封信留下的告别信就此展开，那纸张上拙劣画着一个背起包裹的小人。小人头上有髻，髻间插着一支酒提。

Below the drawing, a few words are written roughly, as if they have been copied from somewhere else.
画的底下，歪歪扭扭地写了几个字，像是从何处生描而来的。

Pandora Wilson: "Alright," "Xiángruì," "Goodbye"...
白雪松： “好”、“祥瑞”、“再见”……

Pandora Wilson: It seems like she has found her own way of walking through walls.
白雪松： 看来，她已找到了自己的穿墙之术，不再需要一个答案。

The night sky outside the window is bright, and firecrackers ring out—it is a night of celebration.
窗外夜空光亮，爆竹响动，已是庆典之夜。

The streets are filled with a sense of peace and tranquility. Firecracker debris is scattered on the ground, silently indicating the excitement of the previous night.
街上一派祥和宁静之意，爆竹碎屑散落在地面上，静静地昭示着昨晚的热闹。

Jiǔ Niángzǐ's tavern is deserted. Its door left wide open, with not a drop of liquor left in any of the jars.
曲娘子人去楼空，她的酒馆门户敞着，缸里不剩一滴酒液。

The foreigners hurriedly make their way towards the city gate.
异乡人步履匆匆，向着城门赶去。

Bessmert: Hm? What's this ...?
别斯米尔：嗯？这是什么……？

Yenisei: What is it, Madam Bessmert?
小叶尼塞：怎么了，别斯米尔女士？

Bessmert: No, it's nothing. It's just that there is a strange business card in my backpack with Braille engraved on it. It seems to say ... "UTTU"?
别斯米尔：不，没什么，只是我的背包中忽然多出了这样一张名片，上面刻着点涂的盲文，似乎是……“UTTU”？

Yenisei: What's that?
小叶尼塞：那是什么？

Bessmert: I'm not sure. Maybe a magazine, or a novel. I feel like I know it from somewhere ... It sounds very familiar to me.
别斯米尔：我不清楚，也许是杂志，也许是小说，我总觉得我从哪儿知道过它……它给我一种很熟悉的感觉。

Yenisei: I see. My mother never allowed me to read books for leisure, and after joining this expedition, I really had no time for reading ... I suppose I know nothing about these kinds of things.
小叶尼塞：原来如此。我母亲从不允许我阅读这样的闲杂书籍，而加入远行队后，更是没有时间用于阅读……我对于这些东西一无所知。

Yenisei: Once we get out of here, I'll help you find more information about it. Don't worry.
小叶尼塞：等我们离开这里后，我会帮您寻找有关于它的信息的。请别担心。

Bessmert: Thank you, child.
别斯米尔：多谢你，善良的孩子。

They go far away, and their voices are muffled and inaudible.
她们走得远了，声音也模糊，听不真切。

The tavern door stands open, and a white letter floats up from the table, shaking off the dust that had settled on it overnight.
酒馆洞开的门户一侧，一张白色信纸从桌面上飘起，抖去一夜落下的灰尘。

Before her lay another sheet of paper. The local chronicle has been completed. The cover depicts a girl with a backpack and bun and a silver hairpin, as if drawn by hand.
她的面前铺开一张稿纸，风土志异已然落成，最为首的封面上，背包梳髻的小姑娘与一枚银钗放在一起，像是随手再次绘上。

Pandora Wilson: Before my old friend knocks on the door of UTTU Magazine—
白雪松：在我的旧友叩响 UTTU 杂志社的门扉之前——

Pandora Wilson: We obviously have our own business to attend to.
白雪松： 我们显然还有各自的事业要忙碌。